

CURE MY NATION INITIATIVE PBOR FULLY EXPLAINED FOR BOT INTEGRATION

Right 1.

Access to Records, Including Explicit Information About Range and Scope of Services Available

This right guarantees that every patient in Nigeria is entitled to full, clear, and timely access to their medical records as well as comprehensive information about the healthcare services available to them within a facility. It is a critical pillar of transparency, accountability, and patient-centered care.

1. What This Right Means

A. Access to Medical Records

Patients have the right to:

Obtain complete and accurate copies of their medical records (diagnosis, test results, prescriptions, treatment history, etc.).

Receive explanations of medical terms in a language they understand.

Request corrections where records are inaccurate or incomplete.

Know who has accessed their records and for what purpose.

This ensures patients can:

Make informed decisions about their care.

Seek second opinions when necessary.

Maintain continuity of care across different providers.

B. Information on Range and Scope of Services

Patients are also entitled to:

Know the types of services available in a healthcare facility (e.g., emergency care, specialist services, laboratory services).

Understand the limits of those services (what the facility can and cannot provide).

Be informed about referral options when services are unavailable.

Receive details on costs, procedures, and expected outcomes of services.

This prevents misinformation and helps patients avoid delays or inappropriate treatment.

2. Patient Responsibilities

To effectively enjoy this right, patients must:

Make formal requests for their medical records when needed.

Provide accurate and complete personal and medical information.

Respect hospital procedures for accessing records (e.g., filling forms, paying approved fees where applicable).

Use obtained information ethically and responsibly, especially when sharing with third parties.

Ask questions when information is unclear instead of making assumptions.

3. Provider (Healthcare Facility) Responsibilities

Healthcare providers have a duty to:

Maintain proper, accurate, and up-to-date medical records.

Ensure records are secure but accessible to patients upon request.

Provide information in a clear, respectful, and non-technical manner.

Inform patients upfront about the services they offer and their limitations.

Establish a transparent system for record requests and retrieval.

Avoid unnecessary delays or denial of access without lawful justification.

Failure to uphold these responsibilities is a violation of the Patients' Bill of Rights.

4. When This Right is Violated

A violation may occur if:

A patient is denied access to their medical records without valid reason.

Records are withheld, altered, or incomplete.

The patient is not informed about available or unavailable services.

There is intentional misinformation about treatment options or facility capacity.

5. How to Seek Redress

If this right is violated, patients can take the following steps:

Step 1: Internal Complaint Mechanism

Report the issue to the hospital management or Patient Affairs Unit.

Submit a written complaint stating the issue clearly.

Request a formal response within a reasonable timeframe.

Step 2: Escalate to Regulatory Bodies

If unresolved, escalate to:

State Ministry of Health

Medical and Dental Council of Nigeria (MDCN)

Nursing and Midwifery Council of Nigeria (NMCN)

National Health Insurance Authority (NHIA) (if applicable)

These bodies can investigate and sanction erring providers.

Step 3: Petition Relevant Agencies

Public Complaints Commission (PCC)

Consumer Protection Council (FCCPC)

They handle cases of service failure and rights violations.

Step 4: Legal Action

Seek legal redress through the courts for negligence, denial of rights, or damages.

Engage a lawyer or legal aid organization.

Step 5: Civil Society & Advocacy Groups

Contact NGOs (like Cure My Nation Initiative) for:

Advocacy support

Public awareness

Mediation assistance

6. Measures to Strengthen Redress

Patients should:

Keep copies of all medical documents and communications.

Document incidents with dates, names, and evidence.

Follow up complaints consistently.

Use written communication rather than verbal where possible.

Seek witnesses or third-party support when necessary.

Healthcare providers, on the other hand, should:

Establish functional complaint desks.

Train staff on patients' rights and communication.

Implement digital record systems for transparency and easy access.

Conclusion

Access to medical records and clear information about healthcare services is not a privilege—it is a fundamental right. When patients are informed, they are empowered. When providers are transparent, trust is built. Upholding this right strengthens the entire healthcare system and ensures safer, more effective care for all Nigerians.

2. Right to Relevant Information in a Language and Manner the Patient Understands

This right ensures that every patient is given clear, accurate, and understandable information about their health condition and care. It emphasizes that communication in healthcare must not just occur—it must be effective, patient-friendly, and culturally appropriate.

1. What This Right Means

Patients are entitled to receive all relevant information regarding:

A. Diagnosis

A clear explanation of their illness or medical condition.

The cause, nature, and severity of the condition.

Whether the condition is temporary, chronic, or life-threatening.

B. Treatment Options

Available treatment plans and alternatives.

Benefits and risks associated with each option.

Expected duration and process of treatment.

C. Procedures

Detailed explanation of any medical or surgical procedure.

Why the procedure is necessary.

Possible discomfort, side effects, or complications.

D. Possible Outcomes

Likely results of treatment (positive or negative).

Chances of recovery or improvement.

Possible consequences of refusing treatment.

2. Language and Manner of Communication

This right goes beyond just giving information—it requires that information be delivered:

In a language the patient understands (e.g., English, Yoruba, Hausa, Igbo, or any preferred local language).

In a simple, non-technical manner, avoiding confusing medical jargon.

With respect, patience, and empathy.

Using interpreters or translators where necessary.

Considering the patient's age, education level, cultural background, and emotional state.

For example, a rural patient should not be expected to understand complex medical terms without proper explanation.

3. Importance of This Right

Promotes informed consent (patients can only consent when they understand).

Builds trust between patient and provider.

Helps patients make informed decisions about their care.

Reduces fear, confusion, and misinformation.

Improves treatment compliance and outcomes.

4. Patient Responsibilities

Patients also have a role in ensuring effective communication:

Ask questions when they do not understand any information.

Inform the provider of their preferred language or need for interpretation.

Provide accurate and complete medical history.

Pay attention and follow instructions given.

Avoid withholding important information out of fear or embarrassment.

Seek clarification before giving consent to any procedure.

5. Provider (Healthcare Professional) Responsibilities

Healthcare providers are obligated to:

Explain medical information in a clear, simple, and understandable way.

Use layman's terms instead of complex medical jargon.

Confirm patient understanding (e.g., asking the patient to repeat key points).

Provide translation or interpretation services when necessary.

Be patient, respectful, and culturally sensitive.

Disclose all necessary information honestly, including risks and alternatives.

Ensure that consent is truly informed, not forced or assumed.

Failure to do this is a violation of ethical and legal standards.

6. When This Right is Violated

A violation may occur if:

A patient is given information in a language they do not understand.

Medical terms are not properly explained.

Important details about diagnosis or treatment are withheld or rushed.

Consent is obtained without proper explanation.

The patient is intimidated or discouraged from asking questions.

7. How to Seek Redress

Step 1: Report Within the Health Facility

Lodge a complaint with the hospital management or Patient Relations Unit.

Clearly state how communication was inadequate or misleading.

Request corrective action or proper explanation.

Step 2: Escalate to Regulatory Authorities

If unresolved, report to:

State Ministry of Health

Medical and Dental Council of Nigeria (MDCN)

Nursing and Midwifery Council of Nigeria (NMCN)

Pharmacists Council of Nigeria (PCN) (if pharmacy-related)

Step 3: Contact Oversight Agencies

Federal Competition and Consumer Protection Commission (FCCPC)

Public Complaints Commission (PCC)

Step 4: Legal Redress

File a case for medical negligence or violation of patient rights.

Seek help from a lawyer or legal aid services.

Step 5: Engage Civil Society Organizations

Reach out to advocacy groups like Cure My Nation Initiative for:

Awareness and guidance

Mediation support

Public advocacy

8. Measures to Strengthen Redress

Patients should:

Keep records of what was said, when, and by whom.

Write down questions before consultations.

Bring a trusted person along if needed.

Request written explanations where possible.

Healthcare providers should:

Undergo communication skills training.

Use visual aids, diagrams, or translated materials.

Establish standard communication protocols.

Monitor patient satisfaction and feedback systems.

Conclusion

The right to relevant information in an understandable manner is central to dignity, autonomy, and quality healthcare. A patient who understands their condition is better equipped to make decisions, comply with treatment, and achieve better outcomes.

Upholding this right is not optional—it is a professional, ethical, and legal obligation in Nigeria’s healthcare system.

Rights 3.

Right to Transparent Billing and Full Disclosure of Costs (Including Recommended Treatment Plans)

This right guarantees that every patient is entitled to clear, honest, and complete information about the financial cost of their healthcare. It ensures that no patient is subjected to hidden charges, unexplained fees, or financial exploitation, and that all costs are communicated before, during, and after treatment.

1. What This Right Means

Patients have the right to:

A. Clear and Itemized Billing

Receive a detailed breakdown of all charges (consultation, laboratory tests, drugs, procedures, hospital stay, etc.).

Understand what each charge represents and why it is necessary.

Be informed of any additional or unexpected costs before they are incurred.

B. Full Disclosure of Costs for Recommended Treatment Plans

Be told the total estimated cost of any proposed treatment or procedure.

Understand the financial implications of different treatment options.

Be informed of cheaper or alternative options where available.

Know the cost of drugs, consumables, and follow-up care.

C. Upfront Financial Communication

Be informed of hospital billing policies, including:

Payment methods (cash, insurance, installment options)

Deposit requirements

Refund policies (if applicable)

D. No Hidden or Unauthorized Charges

Patients must not be billed for:

Services not rendered

Inflated or duplicate charges

Items not previously disclosed (except in genuine emergencies, which must still be explained afterward)

2. Importance of This Right

Promotes financial transparency and accountability in healthcare.

Prevents exploitation and corruption.

Enables patients to plan and make informed financial decisions.

Builds trust between patients and healthcare providers.

Reduces disputes and misunderstandings.

3. Patient Responsibilities

Patients also have obligations to ensure smooth financial interactions:

Ask for cost details upfront before agreeing to treatment.

Request and keep receipts and billing statements.

Inform providers about financial constraints early.

Provide accurate information about insurance or payment capacity.

Pay bills promptly and as agreed, where able.

Seek clarification on any charge that appears unclear or excessive.

4. Provider (Healthcare Facility) Responsibilities

Healthcare providers must:

Provide clear, accurate, and itemized bills.

Disclose all expected costs before commencing treatment (except emergencies).

Explain why each service or procedure is necessary.

Avoid hidden, inflated, or fraudulent charges.

Communicate any changes in cost promptly.

Maintain transparent billing systems (manual or digital).

Treat patients with honesty and fairness, regardless of their financial status.

5. When This Right is Violated

A violation occurs if:

Patients receive unclear or lump-sum bills without explanation.

There are hidden or unauthorized charges.

Costs are not disclosed before treatment.

Patients are overcharged or billed for services not received.

Financial information is intentionally withheld or manipulated.

6. How to Seek Redress

Step 1: Internal Complaint Mechanism

Report to the hospital billing department or management.

Request a review and explanation of the bill.

Submit a written complaint if necessary.

Step 2: Escalate to Regulatory Authorities

If unresolved, escalate to:

State Ministry of Health

Medical and Dental Council of Nigeria (MDCN)

Nursing and Midwifery Council of Nigeria (NMCN)

National Health Insurance Authority (NHIA) (if insured)

Step 3: Report to Consumer Protection Agencies

Federal Competition and Consumer Protection Commission (FCCPC)

Public Complaints Commission (PCC)

These bodies can investigate unfair billing practices and enforce compliance.

Step 4: Legal Action

File a lawsuit for fraud, exploitation, or breach of rights.

Seek compensation where financial harm has occurred.

Step 5: Civil Society & Advocacy Support

Engage organizations like Cure My Nation Initiative for:

Advocacy and awareness

Mediation between patient and provider

Escalation support

7. Measures to Strengthen Redress

Patients should:

Always request written cost estimates before treatment.

Keep copies of bills, receipts, and medical records.

Document any verbal agreements or discrepancies.

Compare bills with services actually received.

Report issues promptly—do not delay complaints.

Healthcare providers should:

Implement standard billing templates.

Display price lists where applicable.

Train staff on ethical billing practices.

Establish functional complaint and feedback systems.

Use digital billing systems to reduce errors and fraud.

Conclusion

Transparent billing is a cornerstone of ethical healthcare delivery. Patients deserve to know what they are paying for, why they are paying, and how much it will cost—without surprises. Upholding this right protects patients from financial abuse and strengthens confidence in Nigeria's healthcare system.

Right 4

Right to Privacy and Confidentiality of Medical Records

This right guarantees that every patient's personal health information is protected, kept private, and only shared with authorized persons for legitimate medical purposes. It is a fundamental ethical and legal principle that preserves dignity, trust, and respect in the patient-provider relationship.

1. What This Right Means

Patients have the right to:

A. Privacy During Care

Be examined and treated in an environment that ensures physical privacy (e.g., use of curtains, private rooms where possible).

Be protected from unnecessary exposure during medical procedures.

Have confidential conversations with healthcare providers without being overheard.

B. Confidentiality of Medical Records

Have all medical records (diagnosis, test results, history, HIV status, mental health information, etc.) kept strictly confidential.

Know that their health information will not be disclosed without their consent, except where required by law (e.g., public health reporting).

Control who has access to their medical information.

Be assured that records are stored securely (physically or electronically).

C. Controlled Information Sharing

Information should only be shared:

With other healthcare professionals directly involved in the patient's care

With explicit patient consent

When required by law or public health interest

Unauthorized disclosure is a violation of this right.

2. Importance of This Right

Builds trust and confidence in the healthcare system.

Encourages patients to speak openly and honestly about their condition.

Protects patients from stigma, discrimination, or embarrassment.

Safeguards sensitive information (e.g., HIV status, reproductive health, mental health).

Upholds human dignity and ethical medical practice.

3. Patient Responsibilities

Patients also play a role in protecting their privacy:

Provide accurate and complete information to healthcare providers.

Clearly state who is allowed to receive their medical information.

Respect the privacy of other patients within the facility.

Keep their own medical documents secure.

Avoid sharing sensitive information carelessly, especially on public platforms or social media.

Inform providers if they suspect a breach of confidentiality.

4. Provider (Healthcare Professional) Responsibilities

Healthcare providers are legally and ethically obligated to:

Maintain strict confidentiality of all patient information.

Store records securely (locked files, password-protected systems).

Share information only on a need-to-know basis.

Obtain informed consent before disclosing information.

Conduct consultations in private settings where possible.

Avoid discussing patient information in public or inappropriate spaces.

Train staff on data protection and confidentiality policies.

Ensure compliance with relevant laws and professional codes in Nigeria.

5. When This Right is Violated

A violation may occur if:

A patient's medical information is shared without consent.

Health workers discuss patient details openly in public places.

Records are accessed by unauthorized persons.

Patient information is leaked to the media or third parties.

There is poor data security, leading to breaches.

6. How to Seek Redress

Step 1: Report Within the Health Facility

Lodge a complaint with the hospital management or Patient Relations Unit.

Clearly describe the breach and its impact.

Request an investigation and corrective action.

Step 2: Escalate to Regulatory Bodies

If unresolved, report to:

State Ministry of Health

Medical and Dental Council of Nigeria (MDCN)

Nursing and Midwifery Council of Nigeria (NMCN)

Health Records Officers Registration Board of Nigeria (HRORBN)

Step 3: Report to Oversight Agencies

Federal Competition and Consumer Protection Commission (FCCPC)

Public Complaints Commission (PCC)

National Human Rights Commission (NHRC)

Step 4: Legal Action

File a lawsuit for breach of confidentiality or invasion of privacy.

Seek compensation for damages caused (emotional distress, reputational harm, etc.).

Step 5: Civil Society & Advocacy Support

Contact organizations like Cure My Nation Initiative for:

Advocacy and awareness

Guidance on next steps

Mediation and escalation support

7. Measures to Strengthen Redress

Patients should:

Keep evidence of the breach (messages, recordings, witnesses where applicable).

Document dates, names, and details of the incident.

Act promptly—report violations as soon as they occur.

Seek support from trusted individuals or organizations.

Healthcare providers should:

Implement strict confidentiality policies.

Use secure digital health record systems.

Conduct regular staff training on ethics and privacy.

Establish functional complaint and whistleblowing channels.

Sanction staff who violate confidentiality rules.

Conclusion

The right to privacy and confidentiality is essential to ethical, respectful, and professional healthcare delivery. Patients must feel safe that their personal health information is protected. When this right is upheld, it strengthens trust and improves

care; when violated, it undermines the entire healthcare system. Protecting patient confidentiality is not optional—it is a legal and moral obligation in Nigeria.

Right 5

Right to a Clean, Safe, and Secure Healthcare Environment

This right guarantees that every patient receives care in an environment that is hygienic, free from avoidable hazards, and secure from harm. It places a duty on healthcare providers to maintain standards that prevent infections, accidents, and threats to patients' physical and emotional well-being.

1. What This Right Means

Patients are entitled to receive care in a healthcare facility that ensures:

A. Cleanliness (Hygienic Environment)

Regular cleaning and disinfection of wards, toilets, equipment, and surroundings.

Proper waste disposal systems, especially for medical waste (e.g., sharps, biological materials).

Availability of clean water, sanitation facilities, and handwashing stations.

Maintenance of sterile instruments and equipment.

B. Safety (Protection from Harm)

Measures to prevent hospital-acquired infections (HAIs).

Safe handling and administration of medications and procedures.

Functional and safe medical equipment.

Emergency preparedness (e.g., fire safety, power supply, emergency response systems).

Proper patient identification to avoid medical errors.

C. Security (Protection from Threats and Abuse)

Protection from physical harm, theft, harassment, or abuse within the facility.

Controlled access to sensitive areas (e.g., wards, operating rooms).

Presence of security personnel where necessary.

Safeguards for vulnerable patients (children, elderly, mentally ill).

2. Importance of This Right

Prevents infections and complications.

Reduces medical errors and accidents.

Promotes faster recovery and better health outcomes.

Ensures dignity and comfort for patients.

Builds confidence and trust in the healthcare system.

3. Patient Responsibilities

Patients also have a role in maintaining a clean and safe environment:

Maintain personal hygiene and follow hospital cleanliness rules.

Use facilities (toilets, waste bins, beds) responsibly.

Follow infection prevention guidelines (e.g., handwashing, wearing masks if required).

Avoid bringing in harmful or prohibited items.

Respect safety instructions from healthcare workers.

Report unsafe conditions (e.g., spills, broken equipment, suspicious activity).

Cooperate with security protocols within the facility.

4. Provider (Healthcare Facility) Responsibilities

Healthcare providers must:

A. Ensure Cleanliness

Maintain strict hygiene and sanitation standards.

Provide clean water and sanitary facilities at all times.

Implement effective infection prevention and control (IPC) measures.

Ensure proper waste management systems.

B. Guarantee Safety

Use sterile and well-maintained equipment.

Train staff on patient safety protocols.

Prevent medical errors through proper identification and documentation.

Provide emergency response systems (fire extinguishers, backup power, first aid readiness).

C. Provide Security

Ensure the presence of trained security personnel.

Protect patients from violence, abuse, or exploitation.

Maintain controlled access to sensitive areas.

Safeguard patient belongings and personal safety.

5. When This Right is Violated

A violation may occur if:

The facility is dirty, unhygienic, or poorly maintained.

There is lack of water, sanitation, or proper waste disposal.

Patients are exposed to avoidable infections or unsafe practices.

Equipment is faulty or unsafe.

There is insecurity, theft, or abuse within the facility.

Emergency systems are non-functional or absent.

6. How to Seek Redress

Step 1: Report Within the Facility

Notify the hospital management or Patient Relations Unit immediately.

Provide details of the unsafe or unclean condition.

Request prompt corrective action.

Step 2: Escalate to Health Authorities

If unresolved, report to:

State Ministry of Health

Hospital Management Board

Environmental Health Officers/Agencies

Step 3: Report to Oversight Bodies

Federal Competition and Consumer Protection Commission (FCCPC)

Public Complaints Commission (PCC)

National Human Rights Commission (NHRC)

Step 4: Legal Action

Seek legal redress for negligence or harm caused by unsafe conditions.

Claim compensation if injury or damage occurs.

Step 5: Civil Society & Advocacy Support

Engage organizations like Cure My Nation Initiative for:

Advocacy and awareness

Support in filing complaints

Public accountability campaigns

7. Measures to Strengthen Redress

Patients should:

Document issues with photos, videos, or written records where possible.

Report problems immediately—do not delay.

Keep copies of complaints and responses.

Seek witnesses if necessary.

Healthcare providers should:

Establish routine cleaning and inspection schedules.

Train staff regularly on infection prevention and safety protocols.

Provide adequate funding and resources for maintenance.

Set up effective complaint and feedback systems.

Conduct regular safety audits and risk assessments.

Conclusion

A clean, safe, and secure healthcare environment is not optional—it is a basic right and a foundation for quality care. Patients should never have to worry about infections, hazards, or insecurity while seeking treatment. Upholding this right ensures better health outcomes, dignity, and trust in Nigeria's healthcare system.

Right 6.

Right to Be Treated with Respect, Regardless of Status or Background

This right guarantees that every patient is entitled to dignified, respectful, and non-discriminatory care, irrespective of their gender, race, religion, ethnicity, alleged criminal status, disability, or economic condition. It is rooted in the principles of

human dignity, equality, and social justice, which are fundamental to ethical healthcare delivery.

1. What This Right Means

Every patient has the right to:

A. Dignity and Respect

Be treated with courtesy, kindness, and professionalism at all times.

Be addressed in a polite and appropriate manner.

Receive care without humiliation, neglect, or degrading treatment.

B. Non-Discrimination

Patients must not be treated unfairly because of:

Gender (male, female, or gender identity)

Religion or belief system

Ethnicity or tribe

Economic status (rich or poor)

Disability (physical, mental, or sensory)

Health condition (e.g., HIV status, mental illness)

Allegation of crime or legal status

Healthcare services must be based solely on medical need, not personal bias.

C. Equal Access to Quality Care

Patients should receive the same standard of care, regardless of their background.

No patient should be denied treatment, delayed, or given inferior care due to prejudice.

2. Importance of This Right

Upholds human dignity and fundamental human rights.

Promotes fairness and equity in healthcare delivery.

Builds trust and confidence in the healthcare system.

Encourages patients to seek care without fear of discrimination.

Improves overall health outcomes and social inclusion.

3. Patient Responsibilities

Patients also have a duty to contribute to a respectful environment:

Treat healthcare workers and other patients with respect and courtesy.

Avoid abusive, aggressive, or discriminatory behavior.

Provide accurate information to healthcare providers.

Follow hospital rules and cooperate with staff.

Respect the rights and dignity of other patients, regardless of their background.

4. Provider (Healthcare Professional) Responsibilities

Healthcare providers must:

A. Show Respect and Professionalism

Treat all patients with dignity, empathy, and compassion.

Use appropriate language and tone at all times.

Respect patients' cultural, religious, and personal beliefs.

B. Ensure Non-Discriminatory Care

Provide care based solely on clinical need.

Avoid bias, prejudice, or favoritism.

Ensure equal treatment regardless of social or economic status.

C. Protect Vulnerable Patients

Pay special attention to vulnerable groups (e.g., disabled persons, elderly, children, detainees).

Ensure they are not exploited, neglected, or mistreated.

D. Promote Inclusive Healthcare

Create an environment that is welcoming and inclusive.

Train staff on cultural competence and anti-discrimination practices.

5. When This Right is Violated

A violation may occur if:

A patient is insulted, ignored, or humiliated.

Care is delayed or denied بسبب bias or prejudice.

A patient is treated differently due to appearance, religion, or financial status.

Healthcare workers display rude, abusive, or discriminatory behavior.

Vulnerable patients are neglected or exploited.

6. How to Seek Redress

Step 1: Report Within the Health Facility

File a complaint with the hospital management or Patient Relations Unit.

Clearly describe the incident and individuals involved.

Request an investigation and corrective action.

Step 2: Escalate to Regulatory Bodies

If unresolved, report to:

State Ministry of Health

Medical and Dental Council of Nigeria (MDCN)

Nursing and Midwifery Council of Nigeria (NMCN)

Step 3: Report to Human Rights and Consumer Agencies

National Human Rights Commission (NHRC)

Federal Competition and Consumer Protection Commission (FCCPC)

Public Complaints Commission (PCC)

Step 4: Legal Action

File a case for discrimination, abuse, or violation of fundamental rights.

Seek compensation for emotional or physical harm.

Step 5: Civil Society & Advocacy Support

Engage organizations like Cure My Nation Initiative for:

Advocacy and awareness

Mediation and support

Public accountability efforts

7. Measures to Strengthen Redress

Patients should:

Document incidents with dates, names, and evidence.

Report violations promptly.

Seek witnesses where possible.

Keep copies of all complaints and responses.

Healthcare providers should:

Establish zero-tolerance policies for discrimination.

Train staff on ethics, communication, and cultural sensitivity.

Create accessible complaint systems.

Monitor staff behavior and enforce disciplinary measures when necessary.

Conclusion

Respect is the foundation of quality healthcare. Every patient, regardless of background or circumstance, deserves to be treated with dignity, fairness, and compassion. Upholding this right not only protects individuals but also strengthens the integrity and humanity of Nigeria's healthcare system.

Right 7

Right to Receive Urgent, Immediate, and Sufficient Intervention and Care in an Emergency

This right guarantees that every person is entitled to prompt and adequate medical attention during an emergency, regardless of their ability to pay, social status, or background. In Nigeria, this principle is reinforced by law (including the National Health Act), which prohibits the refusal of emergency treatment.

1. What This Right Means

An emergency is any situation where a person's life, limb, or health is at serious risk and requires immediate medical intervention (e.g., severe injury, difficulty breathing, unconsciousness, severe bleeding, complications in childbirth).

Patients have the right to:

A. Immediate Attention

Be attended to without delay upon arrival at a healthcare facility.

Be prioritized based on the severity of their condition (triage system).

B. Life-Saving Intervention

Receive stabilization and essential treatment to preserve life or prevent worsening of the condition.

Be given first aid, emergency procedures, or resuscitation where necessary.

C. Care Without Financial Barriers

Not be denied emergency care due to:

Inability to pay upfront

Lack of deposit

Absence of insurance

D. Referral When Necessary

If the facility lacks capacity, the patient must be:

Stabilized first, then

Referred promptly to a better-equipped facility.

2. Importance of This Right

Saves lives in critical situations.

Prevents avoidable deaths and disabilities.

Promotes equity in access to healthcare.

Builds public trust in the healthcare system.

Ensures healthcare providers act with urgency and compassion.

3. Patient Responsibilities

Even in emergencies, patients or their relatives should:

Provide accurate and quick information about the patient's condition.

Cooperate with healthcare providers during emergency care.

Avoid interfering with medical procedures.

Provide identification or contact details where possible.

Arrange for payment or documentation later, after stabilization (as required by the facility).

Treat healthcare workers with respect, even under stress.

4. Provider (Healthcare Facility) Responsibilities

Healthcare providers have a critical duty to:

A. Provide Immediate Care

Attend to emergency cases without delay.

Prioritize patients based on medical urgency, not financial status.

B. Stabilize the Patient

Provide necessary life-saving treatment.

Ensure the patient is clinically stable before any referral.

C. Avoid Denial of Care

Never refuse emergency treatment due to:

Lack of payment

Administrative issues

Personal bias

D. Ensure Proper Referral

Refer patients appropriately if services are unavailable.

Provide referral notes and support continuity of care.

E. Maintain Emergency Preparedness

Ensure availability of:

Trained personnel

Emergency equipment

Functional systems (oxygen, power supply, ambulance services)

5. When This Right is Violated

A violation occurs if:

A patient is refused treatment in an emergency.

Care is delayed due to demand for payment or documentation.

There is negligence or lack of urgency.

A patient is referred without initial stabilization.

The facility is unprepared or lacks basic emergency response systems.

6. How to Seek Redress

Step 1: Report to Hospital Management

File a complaint with the hospital authority or Patient Relations Unit.

Clearly describe the delay, refusal, or negligence.

Request an investigation and response.

Step 2: Escalate to Government Authorities

Report to the State Ministry of Health.

Notify the Hospital Management Board (for public hospitals).

Step 3: Report to Regulatory Bodies

Medical and Dental Council of Nigeria (MDCN)

Nursing and Midwifery Council of Nigeria (NMCN)

Step 4: Human Rights and Consumer Protection Agencies

National Human Rights Commission (NHRC)

Federal Competition and Consumer Protection Commission (FCCPC)

Public Complaints Commission (PCC)

Step 5: Legal Action

File a lawsuit for:

Medical negligence

Wrongful death or injury

Violation of statutory rights under Nigerian law

Step 6: Civil Society & Advocacy Support

Engage organizations like Cure My Nation Initiative for:

Advocacy and awareness

Complaint support and escalation

Public accountability campaigns

7. Measures to Strengthen Redress

Patients and families should:

Document events (time of arrival, staff involved, actions taken).

Gather evidence (receipts, messages, witness accounts).

Act quickly—report violations as soon as possible.

Seek legal or advocacy support where necessary.

Healthcare providers should:

Establish functional emergency response systems.

Train staff regularly on emergency care protocols.

Implement no-refusal policies for emergencies.

Monitor and evaluate response times and outcomes.

Create accessible complaint and feedback channels.

Conclusion

The right to emergency care is a life-saving and non-negotiable right. No one should be denied urgent medical attention due to financial, social, or administrative barriers. Upholding this right is a legal obligation, a moral duty, and a critical measure of a responsive healthcare system in Nigeria.

Right 9

Right to Decline Care, Subject to Prevailing Laws and Upon Full Disclosure of Consequences

This right affirms that every patient has the autonomy to accept or refuse medical treatment, provided that such a decision is made after receiving full, clear information about the implications and in line with existing laws and ethical standards. It reflects the principle that patients are not passive recipients of care but active decision-makers in matters affecting their health and bodies.

1. What This Right Means

Patients have the right to:

A. Refuse or Decline Treatment

Say “no” to any recommended test, procedure, medication, or intervention.

Withdraw consent at any stage of treatment.

B. Make Informed Decisions

Receive complete information about:

Their diagnosis

Proposed treatment

Risks and benefits

Available alternatives

Consequences of refusing care

Only after this disclosure can a refusal be considered informed.

C. Be Respected in Their Decision

Have their choice respected without:

Coercion

Threats

Discrimination or abandonment

D. Understand Legal Limitations

This right is subject to certain conditions under Nigerian law, such as:

Public health risks (e.g., infectious disease control measures)

Mental health conditions where a patient may lack decision-making capacity

Minors, where guardians may make decisions

Court-ordered treatments

2. Importance of This Right

Upholds personal autonomy and freedom of choice.

Promotes informed consent and ethical medical practice.

Builds trust and mutual respect between patients and providers.

Protects patients from forced or unwanted treatment.

Encourages shared decision-making in healthcare.

3. Patient Responsibilities

Patients must:

Carefully listen to and understand medical advice before making decisions.

Ask questions to fully grasp the risks and consequences of declining care.

Take responsibility for the outcomes of their decision.

Communicate their decision clearly and respectfully.

Sign relevant documents (e.g., Against Medical Advice – AMA forms) where required.

Consider the impact of their decision on others, especially in public health situations.

4. Provider (Healthcare Professional) Responsibilities

Healthcare providers must:

A. Provide Full Disclosure

Clearly explain:

Diagnosis

Treatment options

Risks and benefits

Consequences of refusal

Use simple, understandable language.

B. Respect Patient Autonomy

Accept the patient's decision without coercion.

Avoid intimidation, threats, or withdrawal of basic care.

C. Ensure Informed Refusal

Confirm that the patient:

Understands the implications

Is mentally capable of making the decision

Document the refusal appropriately.

D. Continue Supportive Care

Even if treatment is declined, providers should:

Offer alternative care options where possible

Continue basic and supportive care

Maintain a professional relationship

5. When This Right is Violated

A violation occurs if:

A patient is forced or pressured into treatment.

Information about consequences is withheld or inadequately explained.

The patient is threatened, intimidated, or abandoned for refusing care.

Consent is assumed or obtained under duress.

The patient's refusal is ignored or overridden without legal justification.

6. How to Seek Redress

Step 1: Report Within the Health Facility

File a complaint with the hospital management or Patient Relations Unit.

Clearly state how your right to decline care was violated.

Request investigation and corrective action.

Step 2: Escalate to Regulatory Bodies

If unresolved, report to:

State Ministry of Health

Medical and Dental Council of Nigeria (MDCN)

Nursing and Midwifery Council of Nigeria (NMCN)

Step 3: Report to Oversight Agencies

National Human Rights Commission (NHRC)

Federal Competition and Consumer Protection Commission (FCCPC)

Public Complaints Commission (PCC)

Step 4: Legal Action

Seek legal redress for:

Violation of autonomy

Assault or unauthorized treatment

Claim damages where harm has occurred.

Step 5: Civil Society & Advocacy Support

Engage organizations like Cure My Nation Initiative for:

Guidance and advocacy

Complaint support

Public awareness and escalation

7. Measures to Strengthen Redress

Patients should:

Request and keep copies of consent or refusal forms.

Document conversations with healthcare providers.

Involve a trusted relative or witness when making decisions.

Seek a second opinion if unsure.

Healthcare providers should:

Use standard informed consent/refusal procedures.

Document all discussions thoroughly.

Train staff on ethical decision-making and patient rights.

Establish clear complaint and feedback systems.

Conclusion

The right to decline care is a powerful expression of personal freedom and dignity. While healthcare providers are trained to save lives, they must also respect the choices and values of patients. When properly exercised and respected, this right strengthens ethical practice, trust, and patient-centered care in Nigeria's healthcare system.

Right 10

Right to Decline or Consent to Participation in Medical Research, Experimental Procedures, or Clinical Trials

This right ensures that every patient has full autonomy over their involvement in medical research, experimental treatments, or clinical trials. Participation in such activities must always be voluntary, informed, and free from coercion, reflecting the ethical principles of autonomy, beneficence, and justice.

1. What This Right Means

Patients have the right to:

A. Informed Consent

Be provided with clear, detailed information about the research or experimental procedure, including:

Purpose of the study or experiment

Procedures involved

Potential risks and benefits

Alternatives, including standard treatment

Duration and requirements

Confidentiality safeguards

Make a voluntary decision to participate or decline without pressure.

B. Freedom to Decline

Refuse participation at any stage, even after initially agreeing.

Withdraw consent without penalty or compromise to their standard medical care.

C. Protection from Coercion

Patients cannot be forced, intimidated, or manipulated to participate.

Decisions should not affect their access to regular medical care or benefits.

D. Privacy and Confidentiality

Any data collected must be treated confidentially and used only as agreed.

E. Special Considerations

Minors, mentally incapacitated patients, or those unable to make informed decisions must have legal guardians or representatives provide consent.

Research involving such individuals must follow ethical guidelines and oversight by Institutional Review Boards (IRBs) or Ethics Committees.

2. Importance of This Right

Protects patient autonomy and dignity.

Encourages ethical medical research.

Ensures trust between patients and medical researchers.

Prevents exploitation and abuse of vulnerable patients.

Promotes scientific progress with accountability.

3. Patient Responsibilities

Patients must:

Seek full information about any research or experimental procedure.

Ask questions to understand risks, benefits, and alternatives.

Provide truthful medical history relevant to the research.

Make decisions respectfully and voluntarily.

Inform researchers promptly if they wish to withdraw.

Respect confidentiality agreements regarding personal data and study results.

4. Provider (Healthcare Professional / Researcher) Responsibilities

Healthcare providers and researchers must:

A. Ensure Informed Consent

Clearly explain the study, procedures, risks, benefits, and alternatives.

Confirm that patients understand the information.

Provide consent forms in language and format patients can comprehend.

B. Respect Autonomy

Allow patients to accept or decline participation freely.

Do not penalize patients for refusal.

Permit withdrawal at any stage without affecting medical care.

C. Ethical Oversight

Ensure research follows National Health Research Ethics Committee (NHREC) guidelines.

Protect vulnerable populations and maintain ethical integrity.

D. Protect Privacy

Safeguard patient data collected during research.

Use information only for intended research purposes.

5. When This Right is Violated

A violation occurs if:

Patients are forced, coerced, or misled into participation.

Research is conducted without full disclosure of risks, procedures, or consequences.

A patient's withdrawal is ignored or penalized.

Confidential information is misused or disclosed improperly.

Ethical guidelines or national laws governing research are disregarded.

6. How to Seek Redress

Step 1: Report Within the Institution

File a complaint with the Research Ethics Committee, hospital management, or Patient Relations Unit.

Provide details of coercion, misinformation, or rights violation.

Step 2: Escalate to Regulatory Authorities

National Health Research Ethics Committee (NHREC)

State Ministry of Health

Medical and Dental Council of Nigeria (MDCN) or Nursing and Midwifery Council of Nigeria (NMCN)

Step 3: Report to Human Rights and Consumer Protection Agencies

National Human Rights Commission (NHRC)

Public Complaints Commission (PCC)

Federal Competition and Consumer Protection Commission (FCCPC)

Step 4: Legal Action

File a case for unauthorized experimentation, negligence, or violation of consent.

Claim compensation for emotional, physical, or psychological harm.

Step 5: Civil Society & Advocacy Support

Engage organizations like Cure My Nation Initiative for:

Advocacy and awareness

Mediation and complaint support

Public accountability and ethical oversight

7. Measures to Strengthen Redress

Patients should:

Keep copies of consent forms and study documents.

Document discussions, verbal instructions, and any coercion.

Seek witnesses when possible.

Act promptly if rights are violated.

Healthcare providers and researchers should:

Implement strict informed consent procedures.

Train staff on ethics and patient rights in research.

Maintain transparent reporting and oversight systems.

Establish clear feedback and complaint mechanisms.

Conclusion

The right to decline or consent to medical research or experimental procedures is fundamental to ethical and patient-centered healthcare. Respecting this right ensures that scientific progress occurs without compromising human dignity, autonomy, or safety. It protects patients, builds trust, and strengthens the credibility of Nigeria's healthcare and research systems.

Right 11.

Right to Quality Care in Accordance with Prevailing Standards

This right ensures that every patient is entitled to safe, effective, and professional healthcare that meets nationally and internationally recognized standards. It establishes that patients should receive competent care, guided by clinical guidelines, evidence-based practices, and ethical principles, regardless of their background or circumstances.

1. What This Right Means

Patients have the right to:

A. Safe and Competent Care

Care should be delivered by qualified healthcare professionals trained in their fields. Facilities must provide safe environments, proper equipment, and medications that meet quality standards.

Care should minimize risks of errors, infections, or complications.

B. Evidence-Based Practices

Treatment should follow national protocols and international best practices.

Providers must use up-to-date medical knowledge and technologies.

C. Comprehensive Care

Patients should receive care that is holistic, timely, and appropriate to their medical needs.

Care should include prevention, diagnosis, treatment, and follow-up.

D. Continuity and Coordination

Health interventions must be coordinated across departments and providers.

Referrals should be made to specialists or other facilities when necessary.

2. Importance of This Right

Ensures patient safety and minimizes risks of harm.

Improves health outcomes and speeds recovery.

Builds trust and confidence in the healthcare system.

Encourages accountability and professionalism among healthcare providers.

Promotes equity—all patients receive care that meets the same quality standards.

3. Patient Responsibilities

Patients play a role in maintaining quality care:

Provide accurate and complete medical history.

Follow prescribed treatment plans and medical advice.

Ask questions to clarify care, risks, and expected outcomes.

Respect facility rules and guidelines, including infection control measures.

Notify providers of adverse reactions, complications, or errors.

Participate actively in health decisions and follow-up care.

4. Provider (Healthcare Professional) Responsibilities

Healthcare providers must:

A. Deliver Competent Care

Ensure all staff are properly trained and licensed.

Follow established clinical guidelines and protocols.

Maintain professional ethics, standards, and confidentiality.

B. Provide Safe and Well-Equipped Facilities

Maintain hygiene, infection control, and operational safety.

Ensure availability of functional equipment, medications, and supplies.

C. Monitor and Improve Quality

Conduct regular audits, reviews, and training to maintain high standards.

Respond to patient complaints, errors, or adverse events promptly.

D. Communicate Effectively

Explain treatment plans, risks, and expected outcomes clearly.

Encourage patients to ask questions and participate in decision-making.

5. When This Right is Violated

A violation occurs if:

Patients receive substandard, negligent, or unsafe care.

Care is delayed, ignored, or not evidence-based.

Medical errors are concealed or not addressed.

Facilities lack basic hygiene, equipment, or qualified staff.

Patients experience harm due to incompetence or negligence.

6. How to Seek Redress

Step 1: Report Within the Facility

File a complaint with hospital management, Patient Relations Unit, or quality assurance office.

Provide details of the incident, staff involved, and consequences.

Step 2: Escalate to Regulatory Authorities

Medical and Dental Council of Nigeria (MDCN) for doctors

Nursing and Midwifery Council of Nigeria (NMCN) for nurses

State Ministry of Health for facility oversight

Step 3: Report to Human Rights or Consumer Protection Agencies

National Human Rights Commission (NHRC)

Public Complaints Commission (PCC)

Federal Competition and Consumer Protection Commission (FCCPC)

Step 4: Legal Action

File a lawsuit for medical negligence, malpractice, or harm due to substandard care.

Seek compensation for physical, emotional, or financial damages.

Step 5: Civil Society & Advocacy Support

Engage organizations like Cure My Nation Initiative for:

Advocacy and public awareness

Support in filing complaints

Mediation with healthcare providers

7. Measures to Strengthen Redress

Patients should:

Keep detailed medical records, receipts, prescriptions, and communications.

Document errors, delays, or substandard care incidents.

Communicate concerns formally and promptly.

Healthcare providers should:

Maintain continuous quality improvement programs.

Conduct staff training, audits, and performance reviews.

Display patient rights and complaint procedures clearly.

Investigate complaints and implement corrective measures promptly.

Conclusion

The right to quality care ensures that all patients in Nigeria receive safe, professional, and ethical healthcare, regardless of their background. Upholding this right requires collaboration between patients and providers, adherence to clinical standards, and robust accountability systems. Protecting this right strengthens trust, improves health outcomes, and reinforces the integrity of Nigeria's healthcare system.

Right 12

Right to Complain and Express Dissatisfaction Regarding Services Rendered

Every patient in Nigeria has the right to express concerns, complaints, or dissatisfaction about the quality of healthcare services they receive. This right ensures that patients can voice their experiences, whether positive or negative, without fear of reprisal, neglect, or discrimination. The recognition of this right is critical in promoting accountability, transparency, and continuous improvement in the healthcare system.

1. Patient's Responsibility

While patients have the right to complain, they also carry the responsibility to:

Provide accurate information – When lodging a complaint, patients should provide clear, truthful, and detailed information about the issue. Misrepresentation can hinder resolution and may lead to unintended consequences.

Be respectful and professional – Complaints should be communicated in a respectful and constructive manner to facilitate effective dialogue.

Follow established channels – Patients should seek redress through the proper mechanisms provided by the healthcare facility or relevant regulatory bodies.

Document concerns – Keeping records such as receipts, prescriptions, referral letters, or any relevant documents can help substantiate complaints.

2. Healthcare Provider's Responsibility

Healthcare providers have an equal responsibility to ensure that patient complaints are addressed fairly and promptly. Key responsibilities include:

Acknowledgment – Providers must acknowledge receipt of complaints in a timely manner.

Investigation – Conduct a thorough, impartial investigation into the patient's concerns, examining medical records, staff accounts, and service logs as needed.

Communication – Keep the patient informed of the progress and outcome of their complaint.

Remedial Action – Take necessary corrective measures if the complaint is substantiated, which may include staff retraining, procedural adjustments, or other interventions to prevent recurrence.

Protection from Retaliation – Ensure that patients are not discriminated against, denied care, or treated differently due to raising a complaint.

3. How to Seek Redress if This Right Is Violated

If a patient's right to complain or express dissatisfaction is ignored or handled improperly, there are several mechanisms for redress:

Internal Hospital Complaint Channels

Most healthcare facilities have a Patient Relations Office, Complaints Desk, or Quality Assurance Unit. Patients should first direct complaints through these internal channels.

State Health Regulatory Authorities

If the internal process is unsatisfactory, patients can escalate their concerns to state Ministries of Health or Hospital Management Boards.

Professional Regulatory Bodies

For complaints involving professional misconduct, patients may contact the relevant regulatory bodies, such as the Medical and Dental Council of Nigeria (MDCN) or the Nursing and Midwifery Council of Nigeria (NMCN).

Consumer Protection Agencies

Patients can also approach consumer rights organizations or Consumer Protection Councils for legal guidance and intervention.

Legal Action

In cases of severe negligence, harm, or unresolved complaints, patients may seek legal recourse through the courts to claim redress.

4. Measures to Ensure Effective Redress

To ensure complaints lead to meaningful change, both patients and providers should consider the following measures:

Documentation: Maintain records of complaints, responses, and follow-up actions.

Follow-up: Patients should actively follow up on unresolved complaints.

Policy Awareness: Patients should be informed about their rights and the complaint procedures within the facility.

Regular Review: Healthcare providers should periodically review complaint data to identify recurring issues and improve service delivery.

Feedback Integration: Facilities should use patient feedback to inform staff training, operational improvements, and policy updates.

In summary: The right to complain and express dissatisfaction empowers patients to participate actively in the improvement of healthcare services. While patients

must raise concerns responsibly, healthcare providers are duty-bound to address complaints promptly, fairly, and transparently. Effective complaint mechanisms not only safeguard patient rights but also strengthen the overall quality and safety of the Nigerian healthcare system.